Self-Advocacy & Self-Determination Checklist

1 Knowing Yourself & Your Needs

- [ ] I know my strengths and what I am good at.
- [ ] I know what kind of job I want and what works for my family.
- [ ] I understand the problems I might face (childcare, transportation, job skills).
- [ ] I know my rights as a worker (fair pay, time off, workplace rules).
- [ ] I can speak up for what I need at work.
- [ ] I take care of my health and well-being while looking for a job.

2 Job Search & Getting Ready for Work

- [ ] I know where to look for jobs.
- [ ] I have a resume that shows my skills and experience.
- [ ] I can talk about why I would be good for a job.
- [ ] I practice answering interview questions.
- [ ] I am ready to explain work gaps or changes in my career.
- [ ] I know how to ask for better pay or hours.
- [ ] I have a way to look professional online (LinkedIn or social media).
- [ ] I know where to get help with job searching (job centers, career programs).

3 Balancing Work & Family

- [ ] I look for jobs that fit my family's needs (flexible hours, remote work).
- [ ] I have a plan for childcare when I start working.
- [ ] I know my rights for family leave and sick time.
- [ ] I know how to manage stress and balance work with family.
- [ ] I set clear work and home boundaries.
- [ ] I have a backup plan if my child gets sick or something unexpected happens.
- [ ] I talk with my family about my job plans.

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4 Making Good Decisions

- [ ] I make choices that help me and my family.
- [ ] I know where to go for help when I have a problem.
- [ ] I can ask for fair pay and good working conditions.
- [ ] I am comfortable talking about my schedule, pay, or job duties.
- [ ] I adjust my job search if things are not working.
- [ ] I feel confident making decisions, even when it's hard.

5 Finding Support & Connections

- [ ] I have people I can ask for help and advice.
- [ ] I stay connected with job groups or community programs.
- [ ] I feel comfortable asking others about job openings.
- [ ] I reach out to old coworkers, bosses, or friends for job leads.
- [ ] I try to meet new people at job fairs or events.
- [ ] I talk to other parents about balancing work and family.

6 Knowing My Rights & Money Management

- [ ] I know my rights for fair pay, time off, and workplace rules.
- [ ] I have a plan to manage my money while looking for a job.
- [ ] I know about programs that help parents with money (childcare, food, housing).
- [ ] I understand what comes with a job (pay, healthcare, vacation time).
- [ ] I know about taxes and other costs that come with working.
- [ ] I know how to report unfair treatment at work.

7 Learning & Growing

- [ ] I am open to learning new skills.
- [ ] I ask for feedback to improve my job search.
- [ ] I set small goals to keep moving forward.
- [ ] I use free classes or training programs to build new skills.
- [ ] I stay updated on job trends and opportunities.
- [ ] I work on improving my speaking and communication skills.
- [ ] I take care of myself and celebrate my progress.

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